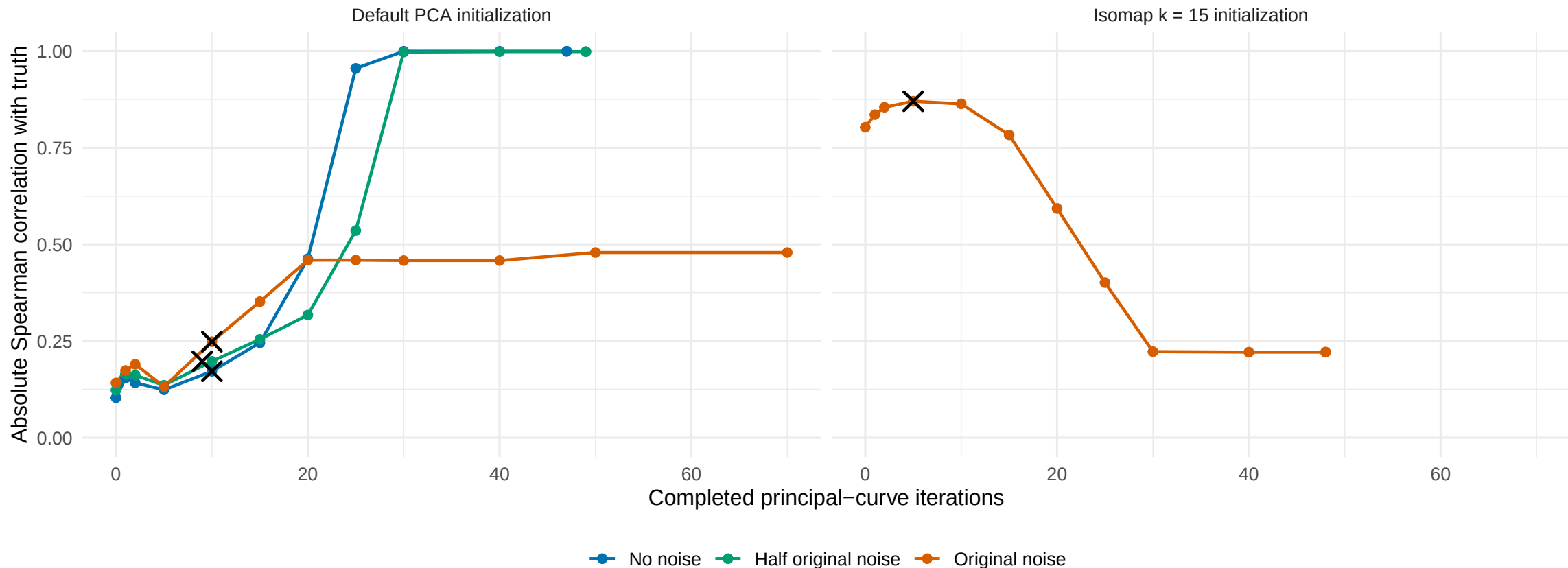


Principal curve: recovery can appear late, or deteriorate with further updates
Saved iteration prefixes from identical starts; black crosses mark the package–default endpoints.



Lines join sampled iteration counts; tighter stopping uses $\text{maxit} = 1000$ and $\text{thresh} = 1e-6$.
The smoother stays at its default $\text{df} = 5$. Truth is used only for evaluation, never to select a stopping point.